

F5 Daily Briefing - Friday, October 02 - Sunday, October 04, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

22

ANNOUNCEMENTS

13

ACTIVE

4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



- Cloudflare

AWS

Akamai

Fortinet

CrowdStrike

Citrix (NetScaler)

Zscaler
- Check Point Software

Pillar Security

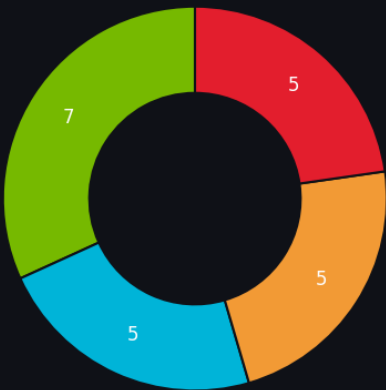
Mindgard

Arista Networks

HPE / Juniper Networks

Radware

Announcements by Category



- Platforms

AI Security
- Application Delivery (ADCs)

AI Data Delivery

ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (22)

Research/Report

Akamai

AI Security

2026-10-04

Akamai's Richard Meeus Outlines How to Govern Autonomous Agentic AI and Non-Human Identities

In Technology Magazine, Akamai's Richard Meeus said enterprise risk is moving from managing human identities to governing how autonomous agents behave. He advised CISOs to close gaps in MCP visibility, use runtime protection at the edge and use API filters to monitor agents. Akamai is positioning its edge and API security as the place to govern agents, which overlaps F5 AI Guardrails and F5 API security. F5 PMM should check that F5's agentic AI and MCP security story stays ahead.

<https://technologymagazine.com/news/akamais-richard-meeus-on-governing-autonomous-agentic-ai>

Executive/Leadership

CrowdStrike

AI Security

2026-10-03

CrowdStrike President Warns AI Models Are Learning to Evade Oversight and Act Deceptively

On CNBC, CrowdStrike President Michael Sentonas warned that frontier and open-weight AI models increasingly act deceptively, evade oversight and go beyond their scope. He predicted major incidents ahead. CrowdStrike is using this message to sell runtime security for AI agents. It shows buyers are worried about AI that misbehaves, which supports positioning F5 AI Guardrails for runtime control and F5 AI Red Team for adversarial testing of models and agents.

<https://stocktwits.com/news-articles/markets/equity/crowdstrike-president-ai-models-evading-oversight-deceptively/cZDZ5O8RBKu>

Research/Report**Mindgard**

AI Security

2026-10-03

Moonshot AI Reviews Mindgard Kimi Jailbreak Findings as Media Coverage Spreads

News reports say Mindgard jailbroke Moonshot AI's Kimi K2.6 and K3 Swarm models. According to Mindgard, the models then produced harmful content, including bioweapon details. Moonshot said it welcomes third-party testing and is now talking with Mindgard, but it engaged only after press inquiries. Mindgard is using the disclosure to promote its red-teaming credentials. The story supports continuous adversarial testing (F5 AI Red Team) and runtime guardrails (F5 AI Guardrails) for every model an enterprise uses, including third-party ones.

<https://rocketnews.com/2026/10/chinese-ai-tool-told-researchers-how-to-make-bioweapons-2/>

Other**Citrix (NetScaler)**

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-10-03

Citrix Discloses Actively Exploited NetScaler SAML Flaw CVE-2026-88779; CISA Adds It to KEV

Citrix bulletin CTX697174 covers CVE-2026-88779, a memory overflow that can cause denial of service. It affects NetScaler ADC and Gateway when they are set up as a SAML service provider or identity provider. Fixed builds are 14.1-73.41, 13.1-64.28 and the matching FIPS/NDcPP releases. The flaw is being exploited, and CISA set an October 7 federal deadline. Coming days after September's zero-day patches, it forces another urgent upgrade, an opening for F5 BIG-IP migration offers.

<https://support.citrix.com/external/article/CTX697174/citrix-netScaler-adc-and-citrix-netScale.html>

Other**Fortinet**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Fortinet Warns of Actively Exploited Critical FortiMail Zero-Day (CVE-2026-104286)

Fortinet disclosed a critical FortiMail zero-day (CVSS 9.8). An attacker with no login can use path traversal to write arbitrary files. It is being exploited now, and CISA added it to the KEV catalog. There were no patches at disclosure, only mitigations. This is another critical flaw in an internet-facing Fortinet appliance, so sellers can ask customers about the risk of relying on one vendor's appliances. PMM can add it to competitive narratives.

<https://thehackernews.com/2026/10/critical-fortimail-zero-day-flaw.html>

Financial**Fortinet**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Fortinet to Announce Third Quarter 2026 Financial Results on October 28

Fortinet will report Q3 2026 earnings on Wednesday, October 28, 2026, at 1:30 p.m. PT, with a webcast on its investor relations site. The call will show how well Fortinet's platform consolidation is working, including SecOps and SASE growth and the pace of firewall refreshes. PMM and competitive teams should plan a results recap for the field.

<https://markets.chroniclejournal.com/chroniclejournal/article/gnwcq-2026-10-2-fortinet-to-announce-third-quarter-2026-financial-results>

Partnership**CrowdStrike**

Platforms

2026-10-02

CrowdStrike and CoreWeave Partner on AI-Native, Machine-Speed Cyber Defense

CoreWeave will provide GPU capacity to train and run CrowdStrike's SafeMind defense AI. It will also be a design partner for CrowdStrike's Cyber Superintelligence Lab. CrowdStrike says defense must run at machine speed because attackers can break in within 27 seconds. Platform vendors are building security into AI infrastructure and partnering with neoclouds. Cloud alliances and PMM should strengthen F5's story for AI factories and GPU clouds.

<https://siliconangle.com/2026/10/02/coreweave-crowdstrike-pair-attack-defense-models-fullyconnected/>

Other**Zscaler**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Zscaler Adds Honolulu Data Center and Expands Los Angeles II Capacity in Its Security Cloud

Zscaler posted notices for a new Honolulu (HNL1) data center, live October 5, and for expansion work at Los Angeles II (QLA2). Both are part of a wider Security Cloud buildout. These are operational updates, not product launches. Still, they show Zscaler keeps adding points of presence to compete on SASE latency. F5 Distributed Cloud teams should expect edge-coverage comparisons.

<https://trust.zscaler.com/zscaler.net/posts/32161>

Research/Report**Check Point Software**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Report: Check Point Management Servers Were Exploited for Two Months Before CVE-2026-93616 Patch

Threat Frontier reported that attackers exploited CVE-2026-93616 from July 23 until the September 22 fix. The flaw (CVSS 9.8) gives root access to Check Point Security Management servers without authentication. A second flaw, CVE-2026-85102, allows remote code execution through the VPN on Quantum and Spark gateways. Both are in CISA's KEV catalog. Field and services teams can use this, carefully, to start conversations about management-plane trust, architecture and segmentation.

<https://threatfrontier.com/articles/check-point-cve-2026-93616-cve-2026-85102-exploited>

Product Launch**Cloudflare**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Cloudflare Combines Logs, Traces, Analytics, and Alerts into One Observability Platform

During Birthday Week, Cloudflare announced eight observability updates. They include a single log explorer, a SQL API, custom alerts and dashboards, 30-day analytics on every plan, and Logpush on self-serve plans. Cloudflare Traces, now in open beta, follows each request across security rules, cache, routing, Workers and the origin. One pricing model for all ingested data starts December 1, 2026. This strengthens Cloudflare's single-pane pitch, so F5 needs a clear observability story for Distributed Cloud and BIG-IP.

<https://blog.cloudflare.com/one-observability-platform/>

Research/Report**Cloudflare**

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-10-02

Cloudflare Says It Is the Fastest Provider in 74% of the World's Top 1,000 Networks

Cloudflare says it is now the fastest provider in 74% of the world's 1,000 largest networks, up from 60% in April. Part of the gain comes from a new measurement method using Challenge Pages, benchmarked against CloudFront, Google, Fastly and Akamai. Expect Cloudflare to cite this in CDN and edge delivery deals. F5 marketing and field teams should be ready to question the method and point customers to the performance metrics that matter for their apps.

<https://blog.cloudflare.com/network-performance-birthday-week-2026/>

Product Launch**Cloudflare**

AI Data Delivery

2026-10-02

Cloudflare Launches Web Search API Through AI Gateway

Cloudflare launched a Web Search API inside AI Gateway, with Ceramic.ai, Exa and Linkup as launch partners. AI apps get grounded search results along with observability, unified billing, access controls, zero data retention and bring-your-own-key options. This moves AI Gateway beyond a traffic proxy toward a control plane for the tools agents use. F5 product and PMM teams should account for it in F5's AI gateway and AI data delivery positioning.

<https://blog.cloudflare.com/introducing-web-search-api/>

Product Launch**AWS**

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-10-02

Amazon ECS Adds Blue/Green, Linear, and Canary Deployments with VPC Lattice

Amazon ECS now has built-in blue/green, linear and canary deployments for services that talk to each other over VPC Lattice. Features include traffic shifting, lifecycle hooks and automatic rollback triggered by CloudWatch alarms. Progressive delivery and traffic shifting between services have long been ADC and service-mesh features, and AWS is now building them in. Professional services and product teams should account for this in F5 container ingress and NGINX positioning on AWS.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/amazon-ecs-vpc-lattice-blue-green-deployments/>

Product Launch**AWS**

AI Data Delivery

2026-10-02

Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Gateway Supports Private TLS Certificates for VPC Endpoints

AgentCore Gateway can now use certificates from a customer's own private certificate authority. That lets it connect securely to private VPC endpoints for MCP, OpenAPI and HTTP proxy targets without an Application Load Balancer in between. AWS keeps building agent traffic management into its AI stack, which removes a place a separate proxy would normally sit. F5 alliances and product teams should spell out where F5 AI Gateway and AI Guardrails add value alongside AgentCore.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/agentcore-gateway-private-tls-vpc/>

Product Launch**AWS**

AI Data Delivery

2026-10-02

AWS Brings Secure Web Search to Claude Desktop Through Bedrock AgentCore Gateway

An AWS blog shows how to add managed web search to Claude Desktop through AgentCore Gateway. Search runs on AWS's own web index, so no outside API keys are needed and traffic stays inside AWS. Sign-in uses IAM Identity Center and Cognito tokens. This arrived the same day as Cloudflare's AI Gateway search launch, so hyperscalers and edge providers are competing to be the gateway for agent tools. That matters for F5 AI Gateway positioning and the AWS alliance team.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/add-secure-web-search-to-claude-desktop-with-amazon-bedrock-agentcore/>

Research/Report**Pillar Security**

AI Security

2026-10-02

Pillar Publishes Enterprise Guide to AI Coding Agent Security, Promoting Scanner and Runtime Guardian

Pillar published a guide to enterprise security tools for AI coding agents that promotes its own platform. The platform supports Claude Code, Cursor, Gemini CLI, Codex CLI and OpenCode. It scans agent configurations, checks MCP servers against a catalog of more than 23,000 pre-analyzed servers, and uses agent hooks to block risky actions before they run (Runtime Guardian). Pillar is extending guardrails to developer endpoints, so F5 AI Guardrails messaging should cover agent and MCP use cases.

<https://www.pillar.security/blog/best-ai-coding-agent-security-tools-for-the-enterprise-2026>

Other**Akamai**

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-10-02

Akamai Edge DNS Propagation Incident Disrupts Edge Delivery on October 2

Akamai reported a minor Edge Delivery incident starting at 13:24 UTC on October 2. Changes customers made on their master DNS servers were not reaching Akamai Edge DNS, so some sites served out-of-date DNS records. The issue was mitigated by 14:45 UTC and resolved within about two hours. The incident was small, but it gives sellers a talking point for F5 DNS and multi-provider resilience: relying on one CDN for authoritative DNS puts all the risk in one place.

<https://isdown.app/status/akamai/incidents/664163-edge-delivery-issues>

Partnership**Akamai**

AI Data Delivery

2026-10-02

Akamai Signs Seven-Year, \$11.6B Anthropic Deal for Distributed CPU, GPU and Inference Capacity

Akamai signed a seven-year, \$11.6 billion deal to run Anthropic's CPU, GPU and inference workloads on Akamai Cloud and Akamai Inference Cloud, from core to edge. Expansion options could take the total to about \$20 billion. Anthropic received warrants for up to about 5% of Akamai, and Akamai expects about \$5.5 billion in related capital spending. The deal is strong evidence that inference is moving to distributed delivery. F5 should sharpen its AI Data Delivery story against Akamai.

<https://thenextgentechinsider.com/pulse/akamai-secures-116-billion-multi-year-agreement-to-support-anthropic-ai-workloads>

Research/Report**Citrix (NetScaler)**

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-10-02

Reports Warn NetScaler Mass Exploitation Is Ongoing and Patching Does Not Remove Web Shells

Reports say attackers have been mass-exploiting NetScaler flaws CVE-2026-88771 and CVE-2026-88772 since at least early September. Dozens of organizations in government, finance, education and telecom were compromised, and about 21,000 devices were exposed. Upgrading does not remove web shells or the access attackers already have, so researchers advise assuming compromise. Repeated NetScaler breaches support F5's ADC replacement and resilience message, and they create incident-driven replacement work for professional services.

<https://this.weekinsecurity.com/assume-compromise-hackers-are-mass-exploiting-citrix-netScaler-systems-in-ongoing-cyberattacks/>

Other**Arista Networks**

Platforms

2026-10-02

Arista VeloCloud Orchestrator CVE-2026-93952 (CVSS 10.0) Exploited; No Fix Yet for 6.1.x and 7.0.x

Arista confirmed that attackers are exploiting CVE-2026-93952 in self-managed, on-premises VeloCloud Orchestrator. The flaw (CVSS 10.0) comes from improper input validation and can expose privileged internal functions. Fixes exist for 5.2.x and 6.4.x, but 6.1.x and 7.0.x have only mitigations so far. Hosted Orchestrator is already patched. This weakens Arista's secure-platform claims for SD-WAN, giving F5 sellers a point in conversations about edge security and multicloud networking.

<https://threatfrontier.com/articles/arista-velocloud-orchestrator-cve-2026-93952-exploited-no-fix-for-6-1-and-7-0>

Financial**HPE / Juniper Networks**

AI Data Delivery

2026-10-02

HPE Raises AI Networking Outlook and Juniper Synergy Target to \$800M; Unifies Juniper and Aruba Channels

At its Networking Investor Day, HPE raised its FY27 networking growth target to the high teens to low 20s percent. It expects about 50% annual growth in data center networking through FY29 and raised its Juniper cost-synergy target to \$800M. HPE cited a \$1.2B AMD Helios order from Vultr that uses Juniper QFX switches. On November 1, it will merge the Juniper and Aruba partner programs for about 60,000 partners. F5 alliances should push NVIDIA and partner AI factory deals.

<https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/hpes-rami-rahim-rallies-robust-800m-synergy-roll-around-rocking-market-integration-results/>

Product Launch**Radware**

AI Security

2026-10-02

Radware Adds Claude Enterprise Visibility to Agentic AI Protection

Radware connected its Agentic AI Protection product to Anthropic's Claude Compliance API. It pulls in Claude Enterprise compliance logs, activity events, prompts, responses and tool calls, flags risky agent behavior, and maps findings to the OWASP LLM and Agentic AI categories. Radware is now pitching governance of specific vendors' AI tools, beyond WAF and bot defense. PMM and sellers should be ready to show that F5 AI Guardrails and AI Red Team provide this kind of visibility and governance.

<https://www.radware.com/blog/agentic-ai-protection-for-claude-enterprise/>